TCS NQT 2027 · SECTION 3 OF 5 · PART A · FOUNDATION (2027 PATTERN)

Verbal Ability Complete Guide

Every topic explained from zero: rules, formulas, diagrams, solved examples and practice questions.

11	43+	110+	20
topics from basic to advanced	solved examples	practice questions	question mini test

ONLINE LEARNING MOCK TEST SERIES · ATC DEVELOPERS

About this guide

Verbal Ability is the third section of the TCS NQT Foundation test. In the updated 2027 pattern it has three task types: Sentence Completion (20 items, 25 seconds each), Passage Recall (4 tasks of 30 s read plus 90 s write) and Email Writing (9 minutes).

How each topic is organised

- **Start from zero:** the idea in plain words.
- **Formulas and rules:** a yellow box to revise quickly.
- **Diagrams:** pictures, charts and tables.
- **Solved examples:** step by step.
- **Shortcuts and mistakes** to avoid.
- **Practice questions:** Basic, Medium and Advanced. Answers are at the end.

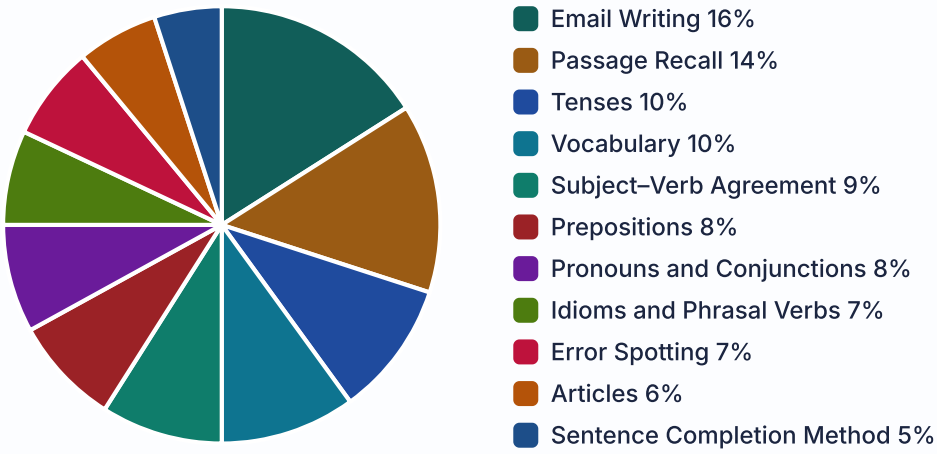
How to study

- Read one topic, then solve its practice set without looking at the answers.
- Check answers and note wrong ones in an error log.
- Revise the formula boxes daily.
- After all topics, take the mini test under the real time limit.
- Follow the priority: do **Must-do** topics first.

Topic priority and contents

1. Tenses	Must-do	2. Subject–Verb Agreement	Must-do
3. Articles	Important	4. Prepositions	Important
5. Pronouns and Conjunctions	Important	6. Vocabulary and Word Choice	Must-do
7. Idioms and Phrasal Verbs	Important	8. Error Spotting and Sentence Structure	Important
9. Sentence Completion: the 25-second method	Must-do	10. Passage Recall	Must-do
11. Email Writing	Must-do		

Where to spend your practice time



Suggested share of practice time per topic. This is our preparation guidance, not an official TCS weightage.

Section strategy

The Verbal Ability section is restructured in the 2027 pattern. It has three task types, and every part is timed per question.

Timeline of the Verbal block (not to scale of seconds)



Sentence Completion: 20 items, 25 s each = 500 s · Instruction screens: 25 s + 15 s
Passage Recall: 4 tasks × (30 s read + 90 s write) = 480 s · Email Writing: 1 task, 9 minutes

The task timers add up to about 26 minutes (1,560 s). In our mock series the Verbal block is counted as 25 minutes so the full test stays at 190 minutes.

Rules of this section

- Every sub-section is timed per question.
- The passage disappears after 30 seconds.
- No section switching after the timer ends.
- No negative marking: attempt everything.
- Typing is needed for recall and email.

Skills tested

- Grammar and vocabulary
- Short-term memory
- Professional written communication
- Typing speed and accuracy

Speed habits

- Use the 25-second routine on every sentence item.
- Practise recall with a stopwatch.
- Keep one email template ready.
- Type 10 minutes every day.

Where marks are lost

- Spending 40 seconds on one sentence item.
- Memorising word for word in recall.
- Long emails with no closing.
- Slow typing.

01 VERBAL ABILITY · MUST-DO
Tenses

A tense tells when an action happens and whether it is finished. Tense errors are the most common blank in sentence completion, so master the twelve forms and the signal words that go with them.

Start from zero

The twelve tenses

	Past	Present	Future
Simple	I worked	I work	I will work
Continuous	I was working	I am working	I will be working
Perfect	I had worked	I have worked	I will have worked
Perfect continuous	I had been working	I have been working	I will have been working

When to use each

Simple present for habits and facts (She goes to school; The sun rises in the east). **Present continuous** for actions happening now. **Present perfect** for past actions connected to now (I have finished). **Simple past** for finished actions at a known time (I finished yesterday). **Past perfect** for the earlier of two past actions (The train had left when we arrived). **Future perfect** for an action finished before a future time (By June I will have completed the course).



Perfect = action completed before a reference time · Continuous = action in progress · Perfect continuous = in prog

Tenses on a timeline

Signal words

every day, usually, always → simple present. **now, at the moment** → present continuous. **since, for, already, yet, just, ever** → present perfect. **yesterday, ago, last week** → simple past. **by the time, before, after** (two past events) → past perfect. **by next month, by then** → future perfect.

Conditionals and reported speech

If + simple present → will (If it rains, we will stay). If + simple past → would (If I were you, I would apply). If + past perfect → would have (If I had left earlier, I would have caught it). In reported speech, the tense usually moves one step back (He said that he was tired). Facts that are always true keep the present tense.

Formula and rule box

- since + point in time; for + duration
- by the time + past perfect (earlier) and past (later)
- If + present → will; If + past → would; If + past perfect → would have
- I wish + past (present wish); I wish + past perfect (past wish)
- Reported speech: present → past, past → past perfect
- Universal truths stay in the simple present

Step-by-step method

1. Find the time words in the sentence.
2. Decide: habit, now, finished, or connected to now?
3. Choose the form from the table.
4. Check it against nearby verbs for consistency.

Solved examples

Example 1. She ___ (go) to school every day.

Solution: 'Every day' signals a habit, so simple present: she goes.

Answer: goes

Example 2. By the time we reached, the train ___ (leave).

Solution: Two past events; the train left first, so past perfect: had left.

Answer: had left

Example 3. I ___ (live) here since 2020.

Solution: 'Since' needs present perfect: have lived (or have been living).

Answer: have lived

Example 4. If it rains tomorrow, we ___ (stay) at home.

Solution: First conditional: if + present → will.

Answer: will stay

Shortcuts

- since/for → present perfect; yesterday/ago → simple past.
- In 'by the time' sentences use past perfect for the earlier event.
- After 'wish' use a past form.

Common mistakes

- Using simple past with 'since'.
- Mixing two time frames in one sentence.
- Using 'will' after 'if' in the condition part.

Practice questions: Tenses

1. He ___ (play) cricket every Sunday. Basic

2. They ___ (watch) a movie now. Basic
3. I ___ (finish) my work yesterday. Basic
4. She ___ (live) in Pune since 2019. Basic
5. By next June, I ___ (complete) the course. Medium
6. When I arrived, they ___ (already/leave). Medium
7. If I ___ (be) you, I would apply. Medium
8. He said that he ___ (be) tired. Medium
9. The sun ___ (rise) in the east. Advanced
10. I wish I ___ (know) the answer. Advanced

Answers: see the answer key at the end of this guide.

02 VERBAL ABILITY · MUST-DO
Subject–Verb Agreement

A verb must match its subject in number. The trick is to find the real subject and ignore the words that sit between the subject and the verb.

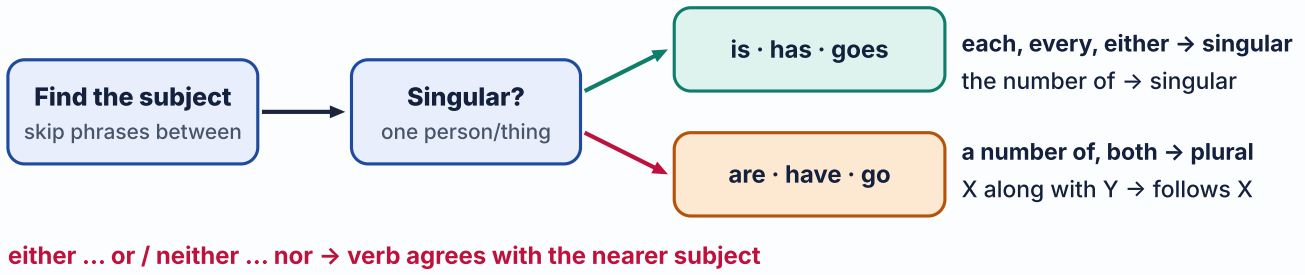
Start from zero

The basic rule

A singular subject takes a singular verb (The boy runs) and a plural subject takes a plural verb (The boys run). Find the true subject first. In 'The list of items is long', the subject is 'list', not 'items'.

Always singular

each, every, either, neither, one, everyone, everybody, nobody, somebody, anyone: Each of the boys has a book. One of my friends is a doctor. Uncountable nouns (information, furniture, advice, news, bread) and subjects like mathematics, physics, news also take singular verbs.



A flow for subject–verb agreement

Joined subjects

With **and** the subject is plural (Ram and Shyam are friends) unless the two form one idea (Bread and butter is my breakfast). With **either...or, neither...nor**, the verb agrees with the nearer subject (Neither the manager nor the employees were present). With **along with, as well as, together with**, the verb agrees with the first subject (The captain, along with his team, is arriving).

Collective nouns and special phrases

A collective noun (team, committee, family) is singular when acting as one unit (The team is winning) and plural when members act separately (The committee are divided in their opinions). **The number of** is singular; **a number of** is plural.

Fractions and quantities

Two-thirds of the work is done; two-thirds of the students are present (the noun after 'of' decides). A sum of money is singular: Fifty rupees is enough.

Formula and rule box

- each / every / either / neither → singular
- The number of → singular; A number of → plural
- X along with Y → verb agrees with X
- Either X or Y / Neither X nor Y → verb agrees with Y
- Uncountable nouns (information, advice, news) → singular
- Subjects of one unit (bread and butter) → singular

Step-by-step method

1. Underline the subject and cross out phrases in between.
2. Decide singular or plural.
3. Check special words (each, number of, along with).
4. Choose the matching verb.

Solved examples

Example 1. The list of items ___ (is/are) long.

Solution: The subject is 'list' (singular), so 'is'.

Answer: is

Example 2. Neither the manager nor the employees ___ (was/were) present.

Solution: The nearer subject 'employees' is plural, so 'were'.

Answer: were

Example 3. One of my friends ___ (is/are) a doctor.

Solution: 'One' is the subject, so 'is'.

Answer: is

Example 4. A number of students ___ (is/are) absent.

Solution: 'A number of' is plural.

Answer: are

Shortcuts

- Mentally delete phrases between commas before choosing the verb.
- 'The number of' singular, 'a number of' plural.
- For either/or and neither/nor, look at the closest noun.

Common mistakes

- Choosing the verb to match the nearest noun in 'list of items'.
- Treating 'each of the boys' as plural.
- Using plural with uncountable nouns like 'news' or 'advice'.

Practice questions: Subject–Verb Agreement

1. Each of the boys ___ (has/have) a book. Basic
2. The team ___ (is/are) playing well. Basic
3. Either of the two options ___ (is/are) fine. Basic
4. Neither the teacher nor the students ___ (was/were) late. Basic
5. The number of applicants ___ (has/have) increased. Medium
6. A number of applicants ___ (has/have) applied. Medium
7. Bread and butter ___ (is/are) my breakfast. Medium
8. Mathematics ___ (is/are) my favourite subject. Medium

9. The committee ___ (is/are) divided in their opinions. Advanced

10. The quality of the products ___ (is/are) poor. Advanced

Answers: see the answer key at the end of this guide.

03 Articles

VERBAL ABILITY · IMPORTANT

A, an and the are small words that appear in almost every sentence. The rules are short and the same few patterns repeat in exams.

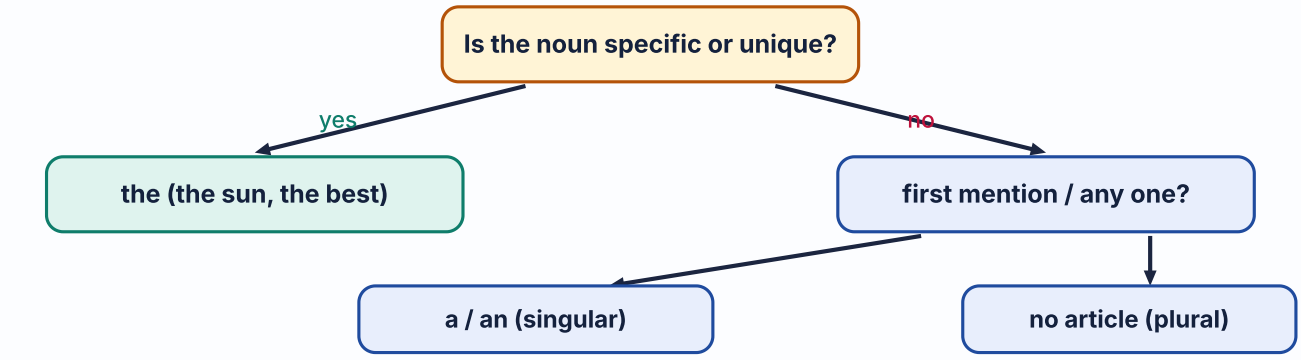
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A and an

Use **a** before a consonant sound and **an** before a vowel sound. It depends on the sound, not the spelling: an hour (silent h), an MBA (em), a university (yoo), a one-rupee note (won). Use them with singular countable nouns when you mean 'one of many' or mention something for the first time.

The

Use **the** when the noun is specific or known to both speaker and listener: the book on the table, the sun, the moon. Also use it with superlatives (the best), rivers, seas, mountain ranges and groups of islands (the Ganga, the Himalayas), musical instruments (plays the guitar) and for something already mentioned (I saw a dog. The dog was big).



Choosing the right article

No article

Do not use an article with plural or uncountable nouns in a general sense (Dogs are loyal; Water is essential), with most names of people, cities and countries, with meals (have lunch), languages and sports (plays cricket), and in fixed phrases (go to school, go to bed).

Common traps

Use 'the' before ordinal numbers and 'the same'. Do not use 'the' before 'most' meaning 'many' (Most people agree). 'What a beautiful day!' needs 'a' because it is exclamatory with a singular noun.

Formula and rule box

- a / an → first mention, singular, one of many
- the → specific, unique, superlative, rivers, ranges
- Zero article → plural/general, sports, meals, languages
- an before vowel sounds: an hour, an MBA
- a before consonant sounds: a university, a European

Step-by-step method

1. Is the noun specific or unique? Use 'the'.
2. Otherwise, is it singular countable? Use a/an by sound.
3. Plural or uncountable in general: no article.

Solved examples

Example 1. ___ honest man was rewarded.

Solution: 'Honest' starts with a vowel sound (silent h).

Answer: An

Example 2. ___ university is at the end of the road.

Solution: 'University' starts with a 'yoo' sound (consonant sound).

Answer: A

Example 3. He plays ___ guitar.

Solution: Musical instruments take 'the'.

Answer: the

Example 4. ___ Ganga is a holy river.

Solution: Rivers take 'the'.

Answer: The

Shortcuts

- Say the word aloud: the sound decides a or an.
- Rivers, seas, ranges and superlatives take 'the'.
- No article before sports, meals and languages.

Common mistakes

- Using 'an' before 'university' or 'European'.
- Adding 'the' before names of countries and cities.
- Omitting 'the' with superlatives.

Practice questions: Articles

1. ___ apple a day keeps the doctor away. Basic
2. He lives in ___ European country. Basic
3. She is ___ best student in the class. Basic
4. I waited for ___ hour. Basic
5. ___ Himalayas are in the north. Medium
6. He is ___ MBA graduate. Medium
7. ___ sun rises in the east. Medium
8. She plays ___ cricket after school. Medium
9. What ___ beautiful day it is! Advanced
10. He goes to ___ school every morning (as a student). Advanced

Answers: see the answer key at the end of this guide.

04 VERBAL ABILITY · IMPORTANT
Prepositions

Prepositions link nouns to the rest of the sentence. Most are learnt as fixed pairs, so a short list of common combinations wins most marks.

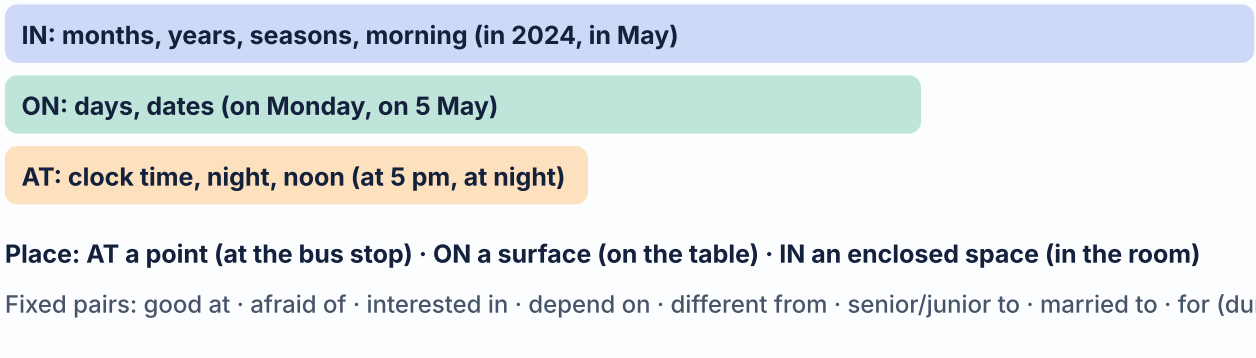
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Prepositions of time

At for exact points (at 5 pm, at night, at noon). **On** for days and dates (on Monday, on 5 May). **In** for longer periods (in May, in 2024, in the morning, in summer). **For** shows duration (for two hours). **Since** shows the starting point (since 2015). **By** means 'not later than' (by Friday).

Prepositions of place

At for a point (at the bus stop), **on** for a surface (on the table), **in** for an enclosed area (in the room). **Between** two things, **among** three or more. **Above/over**, **below/under**, **beside**, **behind**.



Prepositions of time and place

Fixed combinations

good at, bad at, interested in, afraid of, fond of, proud of, depend on, rely on, believe in, different from, similar to, senior/junior to, superior/inferior to, prefer ... to, married to, angry with a person, angry at a thing, apologise for, succeed in, insist on, suffer from, aware of.

Phrasal prepositions

in front of, in spite of, on behalf of, because of, according to, instead of, due to, apart from. These behave like a single preposition.

Formula and rule box

- at + clock time; on + day/date; in + month/year
- for + duration; since + starting point
- between (2) / among (3+)
- prefer X to Y (not 'than')
- senior/junior/superior/inferior + to
- different from; similar to

Step-by-step method

1. Check whether the word is part of a fixed pair.
2. For time words use the at / on / in ladder.
3. For place use point, surface, enclosed.
4. Read the sentence aloud; the correct preposition usually sounds natural.

Solved examples

Example 1. The meeting is ___ 5 pm.

Solution: Exact clock time takes 'at'.

Answer: at

Example 2. She was born ___ 1999.

Solution: A year takes 'in'.

Answer: in

Example 3. He is good ___ mathematics.

Solution: good at.

Answer: at

Example 4. I have waited ___ two hours.

Solution: Duration takes 'for'.

Answer: for

Shortcuts

- at (point) < on (day) < in (period).
- prefer ... to ..., never prefer ... than.
- 'Between' two, 'among' more than two.

Common mistakes

- Using 'since' with a duration and 'for' with a date.
- Saying 'senior than' instead of 'senior to'.
- Mixing 'angry with' and 'angry at'.

Practice questions: Prepositions

1. He arrived ___ Monday. Basic
2. I have lived here ___ 2015. Basic
3. She is afraid ___ dogs. Basic
4. Divide the sweets ___ the two children. Basic
5. He is interested ___ music. Medium
6. This book is different ___ that one. Medium
7. He succeeded ___ passing the exam. Medium
8. We depend ___ rain for crops. Medium
9. He is married ___ my cousin. Advanced

10. She is senior ___ me. **Advanced**

Answers: see the answer key at the end of this guide.

05 VERBAL ABILITY · IMPORTANT

Pronouns and Conjunctions

Pronouns replace nouns and conjunctions join ideas. Questions test the correct case of the pronoun and the right connecting word for the logic of the sentence.

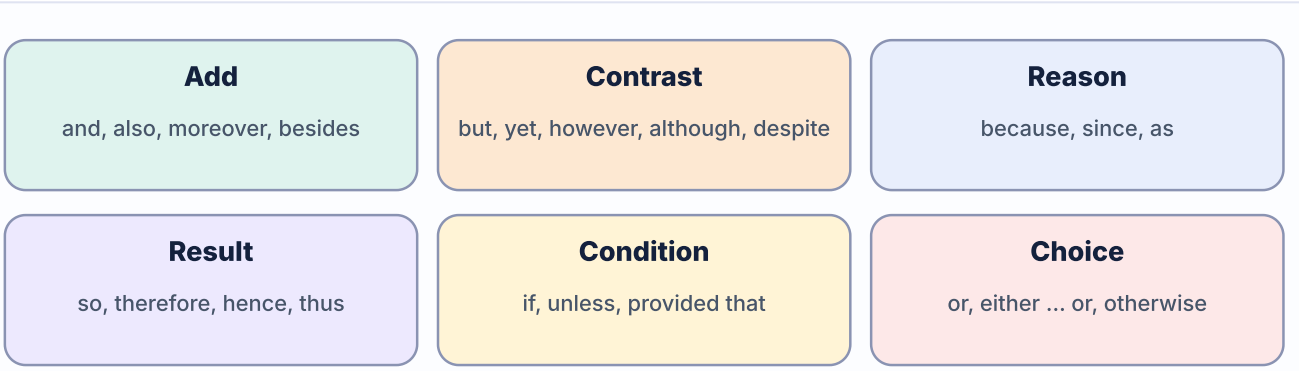
Start from zero

Pronoun cases

Use the **subject form** (I, he, she, we, they) before a verb and the **object form** (me, him, her, us, them) after a verb or preposition. 'He and I went' (subject), 'Between you and me' (object). After 'than' and 'as', complete the sentence in your head: 'He is taller than I (am)'.

Who, whom, which, whose

Who is the subject (the man who called), **whom** the object (the man whom I met), **whose** shows possession and **which** refers to things. **Its** is possessive; **it's** means 'it is'.



Conjunctions grouped by job

Coordinating conjunctions

The seven FANBOYS: **for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so**. They join equal parts. 'He worked hard, yet he failed.'

Subordinating conjunctions

because, since, although, though, while, if, unless, until, whereas. 'Although it was raining, we played.' Do not use 'but' with 'although' in the same clause.

Correlative pairs

either ... or, neither ... nor, both ... and, not only ... but also, whether ... or. The parts after each word must be parallel in form. 'Not only the teacher but also the students were present.'

Meaning of connectors

Contrast: but, yet, however, although, despite. Addition: and, also, moreover. Reason: because, since. Result: so, therefore, hence. Condition: if, unless, provided that. Choice: or, otherwise.

Formula and rule box

- Subject form before verb; object form after verb/preposition
- than / as + subject form if the verb is implied
- who (subject), whom (object), whose (possession)
- its = belonging to it; it's = it is
- either ... or; neither ... nor; both ... and; not only ... but also
- although/though ≠ but
- unless = if ... not

Step-by-step method

1. Decide the role of the word: subject or object.
2. For conjunctions, identify the relationship: contrast, reason, result, condition.
3. Pick the connector that matches the logic.
4. Check pairs: either-or, neither-nor.

Solved examples

Example 1. He and ___ went to the market.

Solution: Subject position: 'I'.

Answer: I

Example 2. Between you and ___, this is a secret.

Solution: After a preposition: object form 'me'.

Answer: me

Example 3. ___ the rain, we went out.

Solution: Contrast with a noun: 'Despite'.

Answer: Despite

Example 4. He worked hard, ___ he failed.

Solution: Contrast: 'yet' (or 'but').

Answer: yet

Shortcuts

- 'Between you and me' always.
- Unless = if not; don't add another negative.
- Match the connector to the relationship before looking at options.

Common mistakes

- Using 'I' after prepositions.
- Using 'although ... but' together.
- Confusing 'its' and 'it's'.

Practice questions: Pronouns and Conjunctions

1. She gave the book to ___ (he/him) and me. Basic

2. ___ you work hard, you will not pass. Basic
3. He is richer than ___ (I/me). Basic
4. Not only the teacher ___ also the students were present. Basic
5. The dog wagged ___ tail. Medium
6. Hurry up, ___ you will miss the train. Medium
7. ___ it was raining, we played. Medium
8. Neither Ravi ___ Ram came. Medium
9. The boy ___ is standing there is my brother. Advanced
10. She is as tall ___ her sister. Advanced

Answers: see the answer key at the end of this guide.

06 VERBAL ABILITY · MUST-DO
Vocabulary and Word Choice

Vocabulary questions test whether you know a word's meaning and can pick the best word for the context. Reading context clues is as important as memorising words.

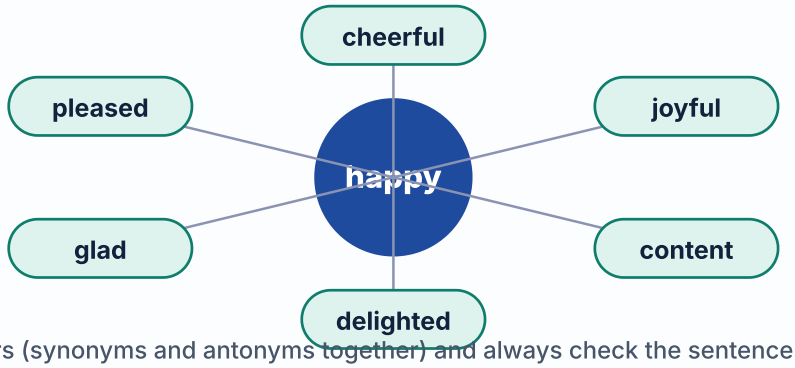
Start from zero

Synonyms and antonyms

A synonym has nearly the same meaning (diligent = hardworking). An antonym has the opposite meaning (scarce ↔ abundant). Words have shades, so always check them in the sentence.

Context clues

The rest of the sentence often gives the meaning: 'The speaker was **eloquent**, so the audience listened with interest.' The clue 'listened with interest' suggests a positive word such as fluent.



Learn words in clusters (synonyms and antonyms together) and always check the sentence context.

A word cluster for 'happy'

Commonly confused words

affect (verb: to influence) / effect (noun: result); principal (head, main) / principle (rule); complement (completes) / compliment (praise); stationary (not moving) / stationery (paper items); advice (noun) / advise (verb); accept (receive) / except (excluding); lose / loose; its / it's.

Collocations

Some words go together naturally: make a decision, take a decision (BrE: take), do homework, heavy rain, strong tea, commit a crime, pay attention. Choose the verb that normally goes with the noun.

Word-learning plan

Learn 10 words a day in clusters with a sentence for each. Revise at 1, 3 and 7 days. See the word bank in the extra pages for 40 high-frequency words.

Formula and rule box

- Find the clue word in the sentence
- Positive clue → positive word; negative clue → negative word
- Use the root and prefix: un-, in-, dis- often mean not
- Eliminate options with the wrong tone (positive/negative)
- affect = verb, effect = noun (most of the time)

Step-by-step method

1. Read the sentence and note the tone.
2. Predict a word before looking at options.
3. Eliminate options that clash in meaning or tone.
4. Pick the closest match.

Solved examples

Example 1. Find a synonym of 'diligent'.

Solution: Diligent means hardworking.

Answer: hardworking

Example 2. Find an antonym of 'scarce'.

Solution: Scarce means rare; the opposite is abundant.

Answer: abundant

Example 3. The medicine had a positive ___ on his health.

Solution: Result of an action is a noun: effect.

Answer: effect

Example 4. The ___ of the school addressed the students.

Solution: The head of a school is the principal.

Answer: principal

Shortcuts

- Predict the answer first and then match the options.
- Learn words in synonym pairs: lucid–clear, frugal–thrifty.
- Remember affect (verb) and effect (noun).

Common mistakes

- Choosing a word with the right meaning but wrong tone.
- Mixing up principal and principle.
- Ignoring the clue words in the sentence.

Practice questions: Vocabulary and Word Choice

1. Synonym of 'frugal'. Basic
2. Antonym of 'hostile'. Basic
3. Synonym of 'lucid'. Basic
4. Antonym of 'obsolete'. Basic
5. The new rule will ___ everyone (affect/effect). Medium
6. Synonym of 'meticulous'. Medium
7. Antonym of 'reluctant'. Medium
8. He gave me good ___ (advice/advise). Medium

9. Synonym of 'inevitable'. Advanced

10. Honesty is a ___ I follow (principal/principle). Advanced

Answers: see the answer key at the end of this guide.

07 VERBAL ABILITY · IMPORTANT

Idioms and Phrasal Verbs

Idioms and phrasal verbs add colour to English. Their meanings are fixed and must be learnt as whole phrases.

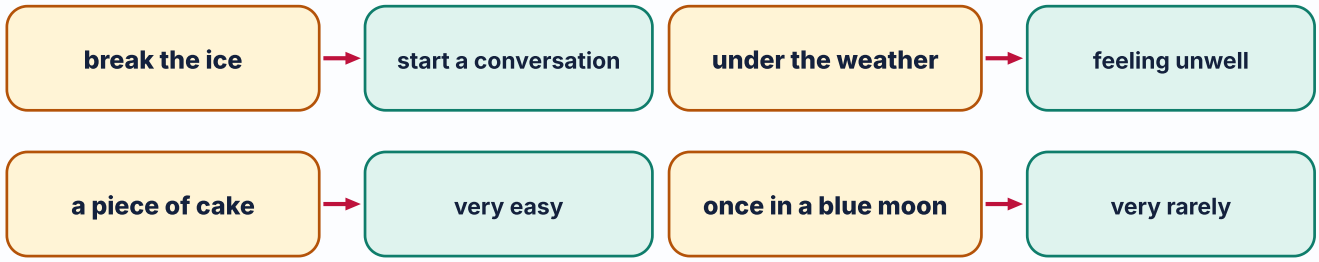
Start from zero

Idioms

An idiom's meaning is different from the meaning of its words. 'Break the ice' does not involve ice; it means to start a conversation. Learn the common ones with their meaning and a sample sentence.

Common idioms

a piece of cake (very easy); break the ice (start a conversation); hit the nail on the head (say exactly the right thing); once in a blue moon (very rarely); under the weather (unwell); the ball is in your court (it is your decision); cost an arm and a leg (very expensive); burn the midnight oil (work late); call it a day (stop for the day); spill the beans (reveal a secret); bite the bullet (face something unpleasant); let the cat out of the bag (reveal a secret by accident).



An idiom's meaning is not the literal meaning. Learn each as a whole phrase.

Idioms and their meanings

Phrasal verbs

A verb plus a particle gives a new meaning: give up (quit), look after (take care of), put off (postpone), carry out (perform), turn down (reject), set up (establish), run out of (exhaust), bring up (raise or mention), come across (find by chance), look into (investigate), turn up (arrive), break down (stop working), call off (cancel), take over (assume control).

How to use them

In sentence completion, decide the meaning you need first (postpone, reject, cancel) and then choose the matching phrasal verb. Watch the particle: turn down = reject, turn up = arrive, turn off = switch off.

Formula and rule box

- put off = postpone
- call off = cancel
- turn down = reject
- turn up = arrive
- look after = take care of
- carry out = perform
- give up = quit
- break down = stop working

Step-by-step method

1. Decide the meaning the sentence needs.
2. Match it to the idiom or phrasal verb.
3. Check the particle (up, down, off, out).
4. Ensure the grammar form (tense) still fits.

Solved examples

Example 1. What does 'break the ice' mean?

Solution: It means to start a conversation in an awkward situation.

Answer: start a conversation

Example 2. What does 'give up' mean in 'He gave up smoking'?

Solution: Give up means to quit or stop.

Answer: quit

Example 3. The meeting was ___ because of rain (put off/put on).

Solution: Put off means postponed.

Answer: put off

Example 4. What does 'once in a blue moon' mean?

Solution: It means very rarely.

Answer: very rarely

Shortcuts

- Learn 5 idioms a day with one sentence each.
- Group phrasal verbs by particle (turn up / down / off).
- Guess the meaning from context first.

Common mistakes

- Translating idioms literally.
- Mixing the particles of phrasal verbs.
- Using the wrong tense with phrasal verbs.

Practice questions: Idioms and Phrasal Verbs

1. Meaning of 'a piece of cake'. Basic
2. Meaning of 'under the weather'. Basic
3. Meaning of 'call it a day'. Basic
4. Meaning of 'look after'. Basic
5. He ___ the job offer because the pay was low (turned down/turned up). Medium
6. Meaning of 'spill the beans'. Medium
7. Meaning of 'carry out'. Medium
8. Meaning of 'burn the midnight oil'. Medium
9. Meaning of 'come across'. Advanced
10. Meaning of 'hit the nail on the head'. Advanced

Answers: see the answer key at the end of this guide.

08 VERBAL ABILITY · IMPORTANT
Error Spotting and Sentence Structure

Many sentence-completion items are error-correction questions in disguise. A fixed scan of eight things catches almost every mistake.

Start from zero

The eight-point scan

1. Subject–verb agreement. 2. Tense. 3. Article. 4. Preposition. 5. Pronoun. 6. Comparison. 7. Word order. 8. Parallelism. Check them in this order; most errors are in the first four.

Common error patterns

He **don't** know (doesn't). She is **more smarter** (smarter: avoid double comparative). The **news are** good (news is). He **suggested me to** apply (suggested that I apply). I **prefer tea than coffee** (prefer tea to coffee). One of my **friend is** a doctor (friends). He is **senior than** me (senior to). The **furnitures are** new (furniture is).



Scan the sentence for these eight things in this order. Most errors fall in the first four.

The eight-point error scan

Parallelism

Items in a list should have the same form. Wrong: She likes singing, dancing and to swim. Right: She likes singing, dancing and swimming. Wrong: To read is better than writing. Right: Reading is better than writing.

Redundancy and word order

Avoid repeating the meaning: 'return back', 'repeat again', 'free gift' (just return, repeat, gift). Keep adverbs close to the verb and place 'only' next to the word it modifies.

Reading strategy

Read the sentence once, listening for what sounds wrong. Then test the eight points. Replace the suspect word with the alternative and check if the sentence works.

Formula and rule box

- Scan order: SV, tense, article, preposition, pronoun, comparison, order, parallelism
- No double comparative: smarter, not more smarter
- Uncountable nouns: furniture, information, advice, news → singular, no plural form
- prefer ... to; senior/junior to
- Lists must be parallel in form

Step-by-step method

1. Read the sentence and note anything that sounds odd.
2. Run the eight-point scan.
3. Fix only the one mistake.
4. Re-read the corrected sentence.

Solved examples

Example 1. Correct: He don't know the answer.

Solution: Subject 'he' is singular, so 'doesn't'.

Answer: He doesn't know the answer.

Example 2. Correct: She is more smarter than me.

Solution: Double comparative: remove 'more'.

Answer: She is smarter than me.

Example 3. Correct: The news are good.

Solution: 'News' is uncountable and singular.

Answer: The news is good.

Example 4. Correct: She likes singing, dancing and to swim.

Solution: Make the list parallel.

Answer: She likes singing, dancing and swimming.

Shortcuts

- Read the sentence aloud in your head to catch awkward spots.
- Check the verb first: most errors involve it.
- If the sentence has a list, check parallelism.

Common mistakes

- Changing a correct part of the sentence.
- Missing double comparatives.
- Treating uncountable nouns as plural.

Practice questions: Error Spotting and Sentence Structure

1. Correct: Each of the students have a book. Basic
2. Correct: I am knowing him. Basic
3. Correct: She has gone to the market yesterday. Basic
4. Correct: One of my friend is a doctor. Basic
5. Correct: He did not came. Medium
6. Correct: I prefer tea than coffee. Medium
7. Correct: The furnitures are new. Medium
8. Correct: He is senior than me. Medium
9. Correct: Scarcely had he left than it rained. Advanced

10. Correct: To read is better than writing. Advanced

Answers: see the answer key at the end of this guide.

VERBAL ABILITY · MUST-DO

09 Sentence Completion: the 25-second method

In the 2027 pattern there are 20 sentence-completion items with only 25 seconds each. Speed comes from a fixed method, not from reading faster.

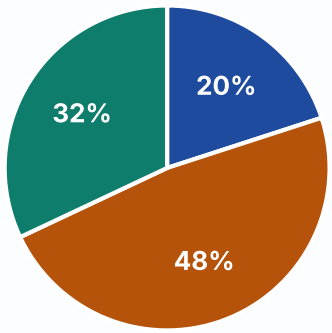
Start from zero

What is tested

Each item gives a sentence with a blank and four options. The blank tests grammar (tense, agreement, articles, prepositions), vocabulary (word choice, idioms, collocations) or logic (connectors). Identify the type in the first five seconds.

The four-step routine

1. Read the sentence once and look at the words around the blank. 2. Decide: grammar or vocabulary? 3. Eliminate options that are clearly wrong (wrong tense, wrong preposition, wrong tone). 4. Pick the best option and move on. Never go back for a second look unless time remains.



Read 5 s
Eliminate 12 s
Choose 8 s

25 seconds per item

1. Read the sentence once (5 s)
2. Spot the type: grammar or vocabulary
3. Eliminate wrong options (12 s)
4. Choose and move on (8 s)

20 items × 25 s = 500 s ≈ 8 min 20 s

How to spend 25 seconds

Smart elimination

Check the verb form first. Check the preposition next. Then check the connector's logic. If two options remain, choose the one that sounds natural in context.

Time and accuracy

20 items × 25 s = 500 s (about 8 min 20 s). Do not spend more than 25 seconds; unanswered items score nothing, so guess when unsure. Practise with a timer until the routine is automatic.

Formula and rule box

- 25 s per item
- Type first: grammar or vocabulary?
- Check order: verb form → preposition → connector → word choice
- Guess when unsure (no negative marking)
- Do not re-read the sentence more than twice

Step-by-step method

1. Read once and spot the blank type.
2. Eliminate wrong options.
3. Choose and move on within 25 seconds.
4. Review the mistakes after each timed set.

Solved examples

Example 1. Despite the heavy rain, the match ___ on time. (a) start (b) started (c) starts (d) starting

Solution: 'Despite the rain' signals a past event, so the past tense 'started'.

Answer: (b) started

Example 2. The speaker's ___ speech kept the audience hooked. (a) monotonous (b) captivating (c) vague (d) tedious

Solution: 'Kept hooked' needs a positive word: captivating.

Answer: (b) captivating

Example 3. If I ___ earlier, I would have caught the train. (a) leave (b) left (c) had left (d) have left

Solution: Third conditional: had left.

Answer: (c) had left

Example 4. Neither of the answers ___ correct. (a) are (b) is (c) were (d) be

Solution: 'Neither' is singular, so 'is'.

Answer: (b) is

Shortcuts

- Decide the blank type in five seconds.
- Eliminate first, choose second.
- If unsure after 25 s, guess and move on.

Common mistakes

- Spending 40 seconds on one item.
- Going back to a skipped item and losing time on the next.
- Choosing an option that is grammatical but changes the meaning.

Practice questions: Sentence Completion: the 25-second method

1. She has been working here ___ 2018. (a) for (b) since (c) from (d) in — Basic
2. He asked me ___ I was coming. (a) that (b) whether (c) what (d) which — Basic
3. The children ___ playing in the garden now. (a) is (b) are (c) was (d) be — Basic
4. He is fond ___ music. (a) of (b) at (c) with (d) on — Basic
5. She speaks as if she ___ everything. (a) know (b) knew (c) knows (d) has known — Medium
6. His ___ attitude made the team uncomfortable. (a) hospitable (b) hostile (c) humble (d) hungry — Medium
7. I would rather ___ at home today. (a) stay (b) to stay (c) staying (d) stayed — Medium

8. Hardly ___ the office when it started raining. (a) he left (b) had he left (c) he had left (d) did he leave — Medium

9. The manager, along with his team, ___ attending the meeting. (a) are (b) is (c) were (d) be — Advanced

10. She did not ___ the offer because the salary was low. (a) turn up (b) turn down (c) turn on (d) turn in — Advanced

Answers: see the answer key at the end of this guide.

10 VERBAL ABILITY · MUST-DO

Passage Recall

Passage Recall is a memory-plus-writing task. A short passage appears for 30 seconds and then disappears; you then have 90 seconds to type what you remember. There are 4 such tasks, each worth the same time (120 seconds).

Start from zero

How the task works

You read a short passage on screen. After 30 seconds the text disappears. You then type the passage from memory in 90 seconds. The score depends on how many key facts you recover correctly and how clearly you write them.

The 30-second reading plan

Do not try to memorise word for word. In the first pass, spot the structure: who, what, when, where, how many. Group the passage into three or four chunks. Pay special attention to names, numbers, dates and the order of events.

One recall task = 120 seconds. The passage disappears after 30 seconds.



Inside the 30 s: spot who · what · when · where · numbers · order

Inside the 90 s: write 3 to 5 short sentences, keep the order, use exact names and numbers

Do not add facts. Do not worry about style. Capture facts first, then fix grammar.

The structure of a recall task

The 90-second writing plan

Write the most important facts first, in the same order as the passage. Use short sentences. Keep names and numbers exact. If you forget a detail, skip it and continue; do not invent facts. Use the last ten seconds to fix spelling.

Memory tricks

Turn numbers into a small story (3 March, 6 weeks). Make a mental picture of names and places. Repeat the key words in your head while reading. Practise with different topics: news, notices, instructions, processes.

Typing practice

You must type fast and accurately. Practise on a keyboard for 10 minutes daily. Aim for 30 or more words per minute with few errors.

Formula and rule box

- Passage visible: 30 seconds
- Writing time: 90 seconds
- Total per task: 120 seconds
- Capture: who, what, when, where, how many
- Write: short sentences, same order, exact names and numbers
- Never add facts you did not read

Step-by-step method

1. Read once, find the structure and underline mentally.
2. Chunk the passage into 3–4 groups.
3. Write the main facts in order within 90 seconds.
4. Fix spelling in the last seconds.

Solved examples

Example 1. Practise: 'Meera runs a bakery in Jaipur. Every morning she bakes 120 loaves and sells them by noon. Last week she added two new cakes, which sold out in three days.' (read 30 s, then recall)

Solution: Key facts: Meera, bakery, Jaipur, 120 loaves, sells by noon, two new cakes, sold out in three days. Model recall: 'Meera has a bakery in Jaipur. She bakes 120 loaves every morning and sells them by noon. Last week she added two new cakes, which sold out in three days.'

Answer: Model recall as above

Example 2. Practise: 'The company will hold a hiring drive on 22 March at its Hyderabad office. Candidates with 0 to 2 years of experience can apply. Registration closes on 15 March.'

Solution: Key facts: company, hiring drive, 22 March, Hyderabad, 0–2 years, registration closes 15 March. Model recall: 'The company is holding a hiring drive on 22 March at its Hyderabad office. People with 0 to 2 years of experience can apply. Registration closes on 15 March.'

Answer: Model recall as above

Example 3. Practise: 'Mount Kala, 5,200 metres high, is climbed by about 800 trekkers every year. The best season is September to November. Trekkers must carry a permit and a first-aid kit.'

Solution: Key facts: Mount Kala, 5,200 m, 800 trekkers, September–November, permit, first-aid kit. Model recall: 'Mount Kala is 5,200 metres high and about 800 trekkers climb it every year. The best season is September to November. Trekkers must carry a permit and a first-aid kit.'

Answer: Model recall as above

Shortcuts

- Capture numbers and names first; fill the rest from logic.
- Write in the same order as the passage.
- If you forget a part, move on; partial recall still scores.

Common mistakes

- Trying to memorise word for word.
- Writing long sentences and running out of time.
- Adding details that were not in the passage.

Practice questions: Passage Recall

1. Read for 30 s, hide the text, then write in 90 s: Riya, a software engineer from Pune, joined Zenith Tech on 3 March. She will work in the cloud team led by Mr Kapoor. Her first project is a billing app due in 6 weeks. **Basic**
2. Read for 30 s, hide the text, then write in 90 s: The annual science fair will be held on 14 December at Greenfield School. Over 40 teams from 12 schools will take part. The winning team will receive a trophy and ₹25,000. **Basic**
3. Read for 30 s, hide the text, then write in 90 s: A new metro line between Airport and Central Station opens on 1 July. It has 9 stations and cuts travel time from 55 to 30 minutes. Tickets start at ₹20. **Basic**
4. Read for 30 s, hide the text, then write in 90 s: Dr Mehta's clinic is open Monday to Saturday from 9 am to 1 pm and 5 pm to 8 pm. It is closed on Sundays. Appointments can be booked by phone or app. **Basic**
5. Read for 30 s, hide the text, then write in 90 s: Last quarter, the company's sales rose by 12 percent to ₹48 crore. The growth came mainly from online orders, which doubled. The CEO plans to open two new offices in Chennai and Hyderabad. **Medium**
6. Read for 30 s, hide the text, then write in 90 s: Arjun lost his wallet on the 8:15 bus to Jaipur. A passenger named Sana found it and handed it to the driver. Arjun collected it the next day from the depot, with all ₹3,500 intact. **Medium**
7. Read for 30 s, hide the text, then write in 90 s: The library will remain closed from 20 to 24 January for stock checking. Members may return books in the drop box. Late fees will not be charged for that period. **Medium**
8. Read for 30 s, hide the text, then write in 90 s: A heavy storm hit the coastal town on Friday night. Power was cut to 5,000 homes. Repair crews restored supply within 14 hours, and schools reopened on Monday. **Medium**
9. Read for 30 s, hide the text, then write in 90 s: To reset your password, open Settings and tap Security. Choose Reset Password and enter your registered email. A link valid for 15 minutes will be sent to you. **Advanced**
10. Read for 30 s, hide the text, then write in 90 s: The training workshop has three sessions: communication on Monday, teamwork on Wednesday and time management on Friday. Each session lasts two hours and starts at 10 am. Lunch is provided. **Advanced**

Answers: see the answer key at the end of this guide.

11 VERBAL ABILITY · MUST-DO
Email Writing

The Verbal section ends with one email-writing task of 9 minutes. A clear structure, a polite tone and correct grammar score well. A fixed template makes it easy.

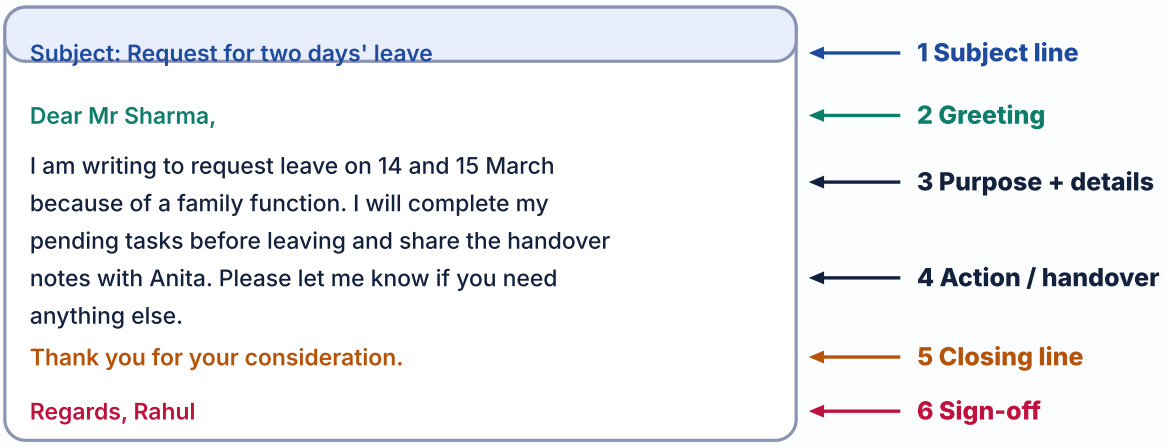
Start from zero

The six-part structure

1. **Subject line**: short and specific. 2. **Greeting**: Dear Mr/Ms Surname (or Dear Sir/Madam). 3. **Purpose**: say why you are writing in the first sentence. 4. **Details**: dates, facts, reasons. 5. **Action or request**: what you want the reader to do. 6. **Closing**: thanks and sign-off (Regards or Yours sincerely, then your name).

The 9-minute plan

Spend 1 minute reading the task and noting the points to include. Spend 6 minutes writing. Spend 2 minutes proofreading for spelling, punctuation and missing points. Keep the email around 120 to 150 words.



Anatomy of a good email

Tone

Use a polite, formal tone. Avoid slang and short forms (use 'I am' not 'I'm' if you can). Use phrases like 'I would be grateful if', 'Kindly', 'Please let me know'. Be positive even in a complaint.

Common email types

Leave request: dates, reason, handover. **Complaint**: problem, evidence, expected solution. **Follow-up**: refer to the earlier message, ask for status. **Apology**: admit, explain briefly, give a fix. **Information or announcement**: what, when, where, who should act. **Request**: what you need, by when, why.

Useful phrases

Opening: I am writing to request / inform / follow up on ... Details: Due to ... / As per ... Request: Kindly arrange ... / I would appreciate it if ... Closing: Thank you for your time and consideration. I look forward to your reply.

Formula and rule box

- Subject → Greeting → Purpose → Details → Action → Closing
- 120–150 words in 9 minutes
- 1 min plan + 6 min write + 2 min proofread
- Formal tone: no slang, no abbreviations
- State the purpose in the first sentence
- One paragraph per idea

Step-by-step method

1. List the points the prompt wants (dates, reason, request).
2. Write the subject line first.
3. Write the body in 3 short paragraphs.
4. Proofread for spelling and tone.

Solved examples

Example 1. Write an email to your manager requesting two days' leave on 14 and 15 March for a family function.

Solution: Subject: Request for two days' leave. Dear Mr Sharma, I am writing to request leave on 14 and 15 March because of a family function. I will complete my pending tasks before I leave and share handover notes with Anita. Please let me know if you need anything else. Thank you for your consideration. Regards, Rahul

Answer: Model email

Example 2. Write an email complaining about a delayed delivery of order No. 4521.

Solution: Subject: Delay in delivery of order 4521. Dear Customer Support, I placed order 4521 on 5 June, and it was due on 9 June. It has not yet arrived. Kindly check the status and deliver it by 12 June, or arrange a refund. Thank you for your help. Yours sincerely, Anita

Answer: Model email

Example 3. Write a follow-up email after an interview on 10 July.

Solution: Subject: Follow-up on interview of 10 July. Dear Ms Rao, Thank you for interviewing me on 10 July for the Analyst role. I enjoyed learning about the team. I would appreciate an update on the next steps. Thank you for your time. Regards, Karan

Answer: Model email

Example 4. Write an apology for missing a meeting.

Solution: Subject: Apology for missing today's meeting. Dear Team, I apologise for missing today's 3 pm meeting due to an unexpected power failure. I have read the minutes and will complete my action items by tomorrow. Please let me know if I should join a call. Regards, Neha

Answer: Model email

Shortcuts

- Memorise a single template and plug in the details.
- Mention every point in the prompt; each is a scoring item.
- Keep sentences under 20 words.

Common mistakes

- Skipping the subject line.
- Writing in an informal tone.
- Running out of time before the closing.

Practice questions: Email Writing

1. Write an email to your professor asking for an extension of the project deadline by three days. Basic
2. Write an email to HR confirming your joining date of 1 August. Basic
3. Write an email to a vendor about a damaged laptop delivered yesterday. Basic
4. Write an email inviting colleagues to a team lunch on Friday at 1 pm. Basic
5. Write an email to your manager reporting that you will be late due to heavy rain. Medium
6. Write an email to your teammate asking for the project report by Monday. Medium
7. Write an email reporting a technical issue in the office Wi-Fi. Medium
8. Write an email thanking a mentor for guidance during your internship. Medium
9. Write an email to cancel a meeting scheduled for Wednesday and propose Thursday. Advanced
10. Write an email to a customer informing them of a price change from 1 April. Advanced

Answers: see the answer key at the end of this guide.

Cheat sheet

Every key rule and formula of the section on a few pages. Revise it daily in the last two weeks.

1. Tenses

- since + point in time; for + duration
- by the time + past perfect (earlier) and past (later)
- If + present → will; If + past → would; If + past perfect → would have
- I wish + past (present wish); I wish + past perfect (past wish)
- Reported speech: present → past, past → past perfect
- Universal truths stay in the simple present

2. Subject–Verb Agreement

- each / every / either / neither → singular
- The number of → singular; A number of → plural
- X along with Y → verb agrees with X
- Either X or Y / Neither X nor Y → verb agrees with Y
- Uncountable nouns (information, advice, news) → singular
- Subjects of one unit (bread and butter) → singular

3. Articles

- a / an → first mention, singular, one of many
- the → specific, unique, superlative, rivers, ranges
- Zero article → plural/general, sports, meals, languages
- an before vowel sounds: an hour, an MBA
- a before consonant sounds: a university, a European

4. Prepositions

- at + clock time; on + day/date; in + month/year
- for + duration; since + starting point
- between (2) / among (3+)
- prefer X to Y (not 'than')
- senior/junior/superior/inferior + to
- different from; similar to

5. Pronouns and Conjunctions

- Subject form before verb; object form after verb/preposition
- than / as + subject form if the verb is implied
- who (subject), whom (object), whose (possession)
- its = belonging to it; it's = it is
- either ... or; neither ... nor; both ... and; not only ... but also
- although/though ≠ but
- unless = if ... not

6. Vocabulary and Word Choice

- Find the clue word in the sentence
- Positive clue → positive word; negative clue → negative word
- Use the root and prefix: un-, in-, dis- often mean not
- Eliminate options with the wrong tone (positive/negative)
- affect = verb, effect = noun (most of the time)

7. Idioms and Phrasal Verbs

- put off = postpone
- call off = cancel
- turn down = reject
- turn up = arrive
- look after = take care of
- carry out = perform
- give up = quit
- break down = stop working

8. Error Spotting and Sentence Structure

- Scan order: SV, tense, article, preposition, pronoun, comparison, order, parallelism
- No double comparative: smarter, not more smarter
- Uncountable nouns: furniture, information, advice, news → singular, no plural form
- prefer ... to; senior/junior to
- Lists must be parallel in form

9. Sentence Completion: the 25-second method

- 25 s per item
- Type first: grammar or vocabulary?
- Check order: verb form → preposition → connector → word choice
- Guess when unsure (no negative marking)
- Do not re-read the sentence more than twice

10. Passage Recall

- Passage visible: 30 seconds
- Writing time: 90 seconds
- Total per task: 120 seconds
- Capture: who, what, when, where, how many
- Write: short sentences, same order, exact names and numbers
- Never add facts you did not read

11. Email Writing

- Subject → Greeting → Purpose → Details → Action → Closing
- 120–150 words in 9 minutes
- 1 min plan + 6 min write + 2 min proofread
- Formal tone: no slang, no abbreviations
- State the purpose in the first sentence
- One paragraph per idea

Word bank: 40 high-frequency words

Learn 10 words a day. Write one sentence for each.

Word	Meaning	Word	Meaning
abundant	plentiful	**authentic**	genuine
accurate	exact	**brief**	short
adequate	enough	**conceal**	hide
ambiguous	unclear	**deteriorate**	get worse
benevolent	kind	**enhance**	improve
candid	frank	**feasible**	possible
diligent	hardworking	**genuine**	real
eloquent	fluent and persuasive	**hinder**	obstruct
frugal	thrifty	**integrity**	honesty
gregarious	sociable	**negligent**	careless
hostile	unfriendly	**plausible**	believable
inevitable	unavoidable	**rigorous**	strict
lucid	clear	**sustain**	maintain
meticulous	very careful	**trivial**	unimportant
obsolete	outdated	**vital**	essential
prudent	wise and careful	**vague**	unclear
reluctant	unwilling	**zeal**	enthusiasm
scarce	rare	**mitigate**	reduce
tedious	boring	**pragmatic**	practical
versatile	adaptable	**resilient**	quick to recover

Email phrase bank

Opening

- I am writing to request ...
- I am writing to inform you that ...
- I am writing to follow up on ...
- I am writing regarding ...

Giving details

- Due to ...
- As per our earlier discussion ...
- The issue started on ...
- I have attached ...

Requesting

- Kindly arrange ...
- I would appreciate it if you could ...
- Please let me know ...
- I request you to ...

Closing

- Thank you for your time and consideration.
- I look forward to your reply.
- Please feel free to contact me.
- Regards / Yours sincerely, (Name)

Email checklist

- ▸ Subject line included
- ▸ Correct greeting and sign-off
- ▸ Purpose in the first sentence
- ▸ Every point in the prompt covered
- ▸ Polite and formal tone
- ▸ Spelling and grammar checked
- ▸ 120 to 150 words

Mini test: 20 questions in 9 minutes

20 items at 25 seconds each (about 8 to 9 minutes). Target: 17 or more correct. No negative marking.

1. He is the tallest boy ___ the class. (a) in (b) of (c) at (d) to
2. She ___ to the gym every morning. (a) go (b) goes (c) going (d) gone
3. I have ___ apple. (a) a (b) an (c) the (d) no article
4. If he ___ harder, he would pass. (a) studies (b) studied (c) had studied (d) study
5. Neither of them ___ ready. (a) are (b) is (c) were (d) be
6. Synonym of ABUNDANT: (a) scarce (b) plentiful (c) tiny (d) weak
7. Antonym of ANCIENT: (a) old (b) modern (c) antique (d) historic
8. He apologised ___ being late. (a) for (b) of (c) to (d) at
9. She is junior ___ me. (a) than (b) to (c) from (d) of
10. 'Once in a blue moon' means: (a) often (b) rarely (c) daily (d) never
11. She ___ a letter when I called. (a) wrote (b) was writing (c) writes (d) has written
12. Hurry up, ___ you will be late. (a) and (b) or (c) but (d) so
13. He did not turn ___ for the meeting. (a) up (b) down (c) off (d) in
14. The news ___ shocking. (a) were (b) are (c) was (d) have been
15. Each of the girls ___ a prize. (a) get (b) gets (c) getting (d) have
16. Correct the error: 'He don't like coffee.'
17. She is more intelligent ___ her brother. (a) from (b) than (c) to (d) as
18. 'Put off the meeting' means: (a) cancel (b) postpone (c) start (d) attend
19. By next year, he ___ his degree. (a) completes (b) will complete (c) will have completed (d) completed
20. The sun ___ in the east. (a) rise (b) rises (c) rising (d) rose

Answer key

1. Tenses

1. plays
2. are watching
3. finished
4. has lived
5. will have completed
6. had already left
7. were
8. was
9. rises
10. knew

2. Subject–Verb Agreement

1. has
2. is
3. is
4. were
5. has
6. have
7. is
8. is
9. are
10. is

3. Articles

1. An
2. a
3. the
4. an
5. The
6. an
7. The
8. (no article)
9. a
10. (no article)

4. Prepositions

1. on
2. since
3. of
4. between
5. in
6. from
7. in
8. on
9. to
10. to

5. Pronouns and Conjunctions

1. him
2. Unless
3. I
4. but
5. its
6. or
7. Although
8. nor
9. who
10. as

6. Vocabulary and Word Choice

1. thrifty
2. friendly
3. clear
4. modern
5. affect
6. careful
7. willing
8. advice
9. unavoidable
10. principle

7. Idioms and Phrasal Verbs

1. very easy
2. unwell
3. stop work for the day
4. take care of

5. turned down
6. reveal a secret
7. perform
8. work or study late
9. find by chance
10. say exactly the right thing

8. Error Spotting and Sentence Structure

1. Each of the students has a book.
2. I know him.
3. She went to the market yesterday.
4. One of my friends is a doctor.
5. He did not come.
6. I prefer tea to coffee.
7. The furniture is new.
8. He is senior to me.
9. Scarcely had he left when it rained.
10. Reading is better than writing.

9. Sentence Completion: the 25-second method

1. (b) since
2. (b) whether
3. (b) are
4. (a) of
5. (b) knew
6. (b) hostile
7. (a) stay
8. (b) had he left
9. (b) is
10. (b) turn down

10. Passage Recall

1. Riya · software engineer · Pune · Zenith Tech · 3 March · cloud team · Mr Kapoor · billing app · 6 weeks
2. 14 December · Greenfield School · 40 teams · 12 schools · trophy · ₹25,000
3. Airport–Central · 1 July · 9 stations · 55 to 30 minutes · ₹20
4. Dr Mehta · Mon–Sat · 9–1 and 5–8 · closed Sunday · phone or app
5. 12 percent · ₹48 crore · online orders doubled · two offices · Chennai · Hyderabad
6. Arjun · wallet · 8:15 bus · Jaipur · Sana · driver · next day depot · ₹3,500
7. closed 20–24 January · stock checking · drop box · no late fees
8. Friday night · coastal town · 5,000 homes · 14 hours · schools reopened Monday
9. Settings → Security → Reset Password · registered email · link valid 15 minutes
10. 3 sessions · Mon communication · Wed teamwork · Fri time management · 2 hours · 10 am · lunch

11. Email Writing

1. Must include: subject line · greeting · reason for the extension · new date · thanks
2. Must include: subject · confirmation of date · documents ready · thanks
3. Must include: order details · the problem · requested action (replacement or refund) · deadline
4. Must include: occasion · date · time · place · RSVP request
5. Must include: reason · expected arrival · how work will continue · apology
6. Must include: what you need · deadline · reason · thanks
7. Must include: problem · when it started · impact · request for fix
8. Must include: specific thanks · what you learnt · hope to stay in touch
9. Must include: cancellation · reason · new time · request to confirm
10. Must include: change · effective date · reason · contact for questions

Mini test answers

1. (a) in
2. (b) goes
3. (b) an
4. (b) studied
5. (b) is
6. (b) plentiful
7. (b) modern
8. (a) for
9. (b) to
10. (b) rarely
11. (b) was writing
12. (b) or

13. (a) up
14. (c) was
15. (b) gets
16. He doesn't like coffee.
17. (b) than
18. (b) postpone
19. (c) will have completed
20. (b) rises